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Electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode

Abstract

An electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode, comprising: a case combining with a side plate and a case cover; a latch bolt, a latch bolt shaft and a latch bolt spring, the front end of the latch bolt shaft is combined with a blocking member, and the blocking member uses the elastic force of the latch bolt spring to stick out of the side plate to lock, when the external force applied to the latch bolt shaft is sufficient to resist the elastic force of the latch bolt spring, the blocking member will retract into the side plate to unlock; a unlock crank, having an electric push member and a manual push member, and a push member relative to the latch bolt shaft; and a linear actuator and an actuating arm, the outer end of the actuating arm is combined with a push block relative to the electric push member, and a push block return spring is set relative to the push block.

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Background/Summary

(1) This patent application is a continuation-in-part of Ser. No. 17/804,325 filed on May, 27, 2022.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The invention relates to an electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode, especially the one that uses a same unlock crank to push the latch bolt shaft to unlock.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) U.S. Patent No. US20160273243A1 disclosed an electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode, it uses a motor to drive the clevis moving through a threaded lead screw for driving a second retraction lever to rotate, and by the rotation of the second retraction lever, it can against the biasing

force that latch bolt spring applied to the latch bolt, so as to retract the latch bolt to unlock; moreover, when the user wants to restore the latch bolt to the locked state, stop the power supply to the motor, use the spring installed on the screw to reset the clevis, and use the latch bolt spring to reset the latch bolt; Furthermore, a key can also be used to rotate a key cylinder to drive a bolt lever to rotate, and then through the rotation of the bolt lever, the biasing force exerted by the latch bolt spring on the latch bolt can be resisted, make the latch bolt be retracted to unlock, and when the key is reset, the latch bolt is simultaneously reset by the latch bolt spring.

(3) However, the prior art above mentioned can use a motor to unlock the lock electrically or manually with a key, and the motor uses the second retraction lever to retract the latch bolt to unlock, and the key uses the bolt lever to retract the lock bolt to unlock, so that the prior art above mentioned must be simultaneously installed with the second retraction lever and the bolt lever, the assembly procedure and the number of components are relatively complicated. In addition, the spring installed on the screw to reset the clevis should be a compression spring to resist the self-locking force of the motor. Since the restoring force of the compression spring must be adjusted through the combination of the diameter and length of the spring, the restoring force of the compression spring is difficult to adjust to an appropriate value. When the restoring force of the compression spring for resetting the clevis is too large, the resistance of the motor during electric unlocking will be too large, and the time required to complete the electric unlocking will be prolonged (even the lock cannot be unlocked). On the contrary, if the restoring force of the compression spring for resetting the clevis is too small, the restoring force of the latch bolt spring must be used to resist the self-locking force of the motor, so that the bolt may not be able to return to the locked state normally; Therefore, if the spring is only a linear compression spring, because the longer the distance of the compression spring is when the elastic force is released, the elastic force will decrease significantly, so there is a problem that the spring restoring force against the self-locking force of the motor will be difficult to adjust.

(4) U.S. Pat. No. 5,953,942 disclosed a door lock comprises a driver hub connected to a door lever, a driven hub, a latch lever movable by the driven hub for retracting the lock's bolt to open the lock, and a catch mechanism for selectively connecting the driver hub to the driven hub. The catch mechanism includes an idle position in which the driver hub moves without moving the driven hub and an engaged position in which the driver hub moves the driven hub and thus the lever and the bolt. A state selection mechanism is provided to displace the catch mechanism between its idle and engaged positions. An actuating mechanism, e.g. a solenoid, selectively positions the state selection mechanism such that the latter causes the catch mechanism, when driven by the driver hub, to adopt one of its idle and engaged positions such that the catch mechanism respectively drives, or not, the driven hub. The actuating mechanism thus allows the state selection mechanism to mechanically cause the catch mechanism to selectively connect or disconnect the driver hub from the driven hub and thus to respectively unlock or maintain locked the door lock. The actuating mechanism typically allows the state selection mechanism to position the catch mechanism in its engaged position, i.e. in its door unlocking position, when activated by a current which results from a valid entry having been recorded in an electronic access control system, or the like. However, this patent is using the actuator mechanism to achieve access control effect, and it has to keep energized to achieve unlocking from outside.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) It is a primary objective of the present invention to solve the problems of the prior art that the assembly process and the number of components are relatively complex, and has the effect of simplifying the assembly process and the number of components.

(6) It is another objective of the present invention to has the effect of using a torsion spring to make it easier to adjust the spring restoring force that resists the self-locking force of the motor.

(7) In order to achieve the above objectives, the present invention comprise: a case combining with a side plate and a case cover; a latch bolt, a latch bolt shaft and a latch bolt spring are arranged

inside the case, the front end of the latch bolt shaft is combined with a blocking member, and the blocking member uses the elastic force of the latch bolt spring to stick out of the side plate to lock, when the external force applied to the latch bolt shaft is sufficient to resist the elastic force of the latch bolt spring, the blocking member will retract into the side plate to unlock; a unlock crank pivoted inside the case, having an electric push member, and a push member relative to the latch bolt shaft; and a linear actuator is arranged inside the case and has an actuating arm, the front end of the actuating arm is combined with a push block relative to the electric push member, and a push block return spring is set relative to the push block.

(8) Also, the unlock crank further include a manual push member, a lock cylinder arranged inside the case, and an actuating cam wheel relative to the manual push member.

(9) Also, the push block return spring is a torsion spring, the torsion spring is set on the case or the case cover by using a first shoulder bolt, the first rotating arm of the torsion spring is positioned on the case or the case cover, the outer end of a second rotating arm of the torsion spring is against the front edge of the push block; wherein the first rotating arm of the torsion spring is positioned on the case or the case cover by a second shoulder bolt or a positioning hole. The linear actuator is a linear stepping motor. The latch bolt shaft and the latch bolt spring are set inside the case by using a latch bolt bracket.

(10) Whereby, whether the push block is pushed forward by the actuating arm of the linear actuator, the unlock crank is pushed and rotated through the electric push member, and the latch bolt shaft is pushed by the push member, so that the blocking member is retracted into the side plate and the lock is electrically unlocked; Or use the key to insert the lock cylinder to rotate the actuating cam wheel, push the unlock crank through the manual push member, and the latch bolt shaft is pushed by the push member, so that the blocking member is retracted into the side plate and the lock is manually unlocked, both of two are all using the same the unlock crank pushes the latch bolt shaft to unlock.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective views of the structure of the present invention;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a perspective views of the main structure of the present invention;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a perspective views of the unlock crank of the present invention;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating locked state of the present invention;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram illustrating electric unlocked state of the present invention;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram illustrating manual unlocked state of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

(7) Referring to FIGS. 1-3, the present invention includes: a case **10** combining with a side plate **11** and a case cover **12**; a latch bolt **20**, a latch bolt shaft **21** and a latch bolt spring **22** are arranged inside the case **10** by using a latch bolt bracket **23**, the front end of the latch bolt shaft **21** has a combining member **25**, and the rear end of the latch bolt shaft **21** having a controlling member **26**, the combining member **25** is combined with a blocking member **24**, the latch bolt spring **22** is sleeved on the latch bolt shaft **21** and arranged between the latch bolt bracket **23** and the combining member **25**, and the blocking member **24** uses the elastic force of the latch bolt spring **22** to stick out of the side plate **11** to lock, when the external force applied to the latch bolt shaft **21** is sufficient to resist the elastic force of the latch bolt spring **22**, the blocking member **24** will retract into the side plate **11** to unlock; a unlock crank **30** pivoted inside the case **10**, having an electric push member **31** and a manual push member **32**, and a push member **33** relative to the controlling member **26** of the latch bolt shaft **21**; A linear actuator **40** is arranged inside the case **10** and has an actuating arm **41**, the outer end of the actuating arm **41** is combined with a push block **42** relative to

the electric push member **31**, and torsion spring **43** is set as a push block return spring relative to the push block **42**, the torsion spring **43** is set on the case **10** or the case cover **12** by using a first shoulder bolt **44**, the first rotating arm **431** of the torsion spring **43** is positioned on the case **10** or the case cover **12** by a second shoulder bolt **45** or a positioning hole, the outer end of a second rotating arm **432** of the torsion spring **43** is against the front edge of the push block **42**; in this embodiment, further includes a lock cylinder **50** arranged inside the case **10**, and an actuating cam wheel **51** relative to the manual push member **32**.

(8) With the feature disclosed above, as FIG. **4** showing, the blocking member **24** uses the elastic force of the latch bolt spring **22** to stick out of the side plate **11** to lock. While unlocking, as FIG. **5** showing, using the energized linear actuator **40** to cause the actuating arm **41** to extend outward, by the pushing of the push block **42** to push the electric push member **31** then further rotating the unlock crank **30**, and using the push member **33** to push the controlling member **26** of the latch bolt shaft **21** to push the latch bolt shaft **21** toward the rear end, so as to make the blocking member **24** retract into the side plate **11** to unlock; When the linear actuator **40** is powered off, the push block **42** is reset by the torsion spring **43**, the blocking member **24** and the unlock crank **30** are reset by the latch bolt spring **22**, so as to restore to the locked state, as showing in FIG. **4**. Alternatively, as showing in FIG. **6**, use the key to insert the lock cylinder **50** to rotate the actuating cam wheel **51**, push the unlock crank **30** through the manual push member **32** by the actuating cam wheel **51**, and the push member **33** pushes the controlling member **26** of the latch bolt shaft **21** to push the latch bolt shaft **21** toward the rear end, so that the blocking member **24** is retracted into the side plate **11** and the lock is manually unlocked; The actuating cam wheel **51** is reset with the rotation of the key, the blocking member **24** and the unlock crank **30** are reset by the latch bolt spring **22**, so as to restore to the locked state, as showing in FIG. **4**. Therefore, the present invention is using the same unlock crank **30** to push the latch bolt shaft **21** to unlock during the electric unlocking or manual unlocking, which has the effect of simplifying the assembly procedure and the number of components. Therefore, the present invention is quite different in structure and achieving effect comparing with U.S. Pat. No. 5,953,942.

(9) In addition, when the linear actuator **40** is powered off and returning to the locked state from the electric unlocking state, the torsion spring **43** set relatively to the push block **42** can provide a restoring elastic force against the self-locking force of the linear actuator **40** for rest the push block **42**, the blocking member **24** uses the elastic force of the latch bolt spring **22** to stick out of the side plate **11** to lock; since the spring restoring force of the torsion spring **43** is easier to adjust to an appropriate value (compared to the linear compression spring), the present invention also has the effect of using the torsion spring to make the spring restoring force resisting the self-locking force of the motor easier to adjust.

(10) Although particular embodiments of the invention have been described in detail for purposes of illustration, various modifications and enhancements may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, the invention is not to be limited except as by the appended claims.

Claims

1. An electric lock with electric and manual unlock modes, said electric lock comprising: a case combining with a side plate and a case cover, the case configured for mounting on one of a door and door frame; a latch bolt, a latch bolt shaft and a latch bolt spring are arranged inside the case by using a latch bolt bracket, a front end of the latch bolt shaft having a combining member, and a rear end of the latch bolt shaft having a controlling member, the combining member is combined with a blocking member for blocking the other of the door and door frame, the latch bolt spring is sleeved on the latch bolt shaft and arranged between the latch bolt bracket and the combining member, and the blocking member uses the compressing elastic force of the latch bolt spring to extend out of an

opening in the side plate to form a lock state, when an external force applied to the latch bolt shaft is sufficient to resist the compressing elastic force of the latch bolt spring, the blocking member will retract into the side plate to form an unlock state; a unlock crank pivoted inside the case, having an electric push member and a manual push member, and a push member relative to the controlling member of the latch bolt shaft; and a linear actuator is arranged inside the case and has an actuating arm, the front end of the actuating arm is combined with a push block relative to the electric push member, the linear actuator is energized to cause the actuating arm to extend outward, and the push block pushes the electric push member to push the unlocking crank, and the push member pushes the controlling member of the latch bolt shaft to pull toward the rear end, causing the blocking member to retract into the side plate to electrically unlock the lock; and a push block return spring is set relative to the push block, the linear actuator is powered off, the push block is restored by the push block return spring, the blocking member and the unlocking crank are restored by the push block return spring, and the push block return spring is extended out of the side plate and restored to form the locked state; and a lock cylinder arranged inside the case, and an actuating cam wheel relative to the manual push member, using the key to insert the lock cylinder to rotate the actuating cam wheel, push the unlock crank through the manual push member by the actuating cam wheel, and the push member pushes the controlling member of the latch bolt shaft to push the latch bolt shaft toward the rear end, so that the blocking member is retracted into the side plate and the lock is manually unlocked.

2. The electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode as claimed in claim 1, wherein the push block return spring is a torsion spring, the torsion spring is set on the case or the case cover by using a first shoulder bolt, the first rotating arm of the torsion spring is positioned on the case or the case cover, the outer end of a second rotating arm of the torsion spring is against the front edge of the push block.

3. The electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode as claimed in claim 2, wherein the first rotating arm of the torsion spring is positioned on the case or the case cover by a second shoulder bolt or a positioning hole.

4. The electric lock with electric and manual unlock mode as claimed in claim 1, wherein the linear actuator is a linear stepping motor.
